

Create a Market Trend Report for Provide a forward-looking outlook on the demand for maritime, shipping, and transport sector advisory services through 2030. What are the major drivers (PE consolidation, fleet renewal, decarbonization compliance, geopolitical realignment, port automation, supply-chain restructuring), and how is the advisory market expected to evolve in size, structure, and specialization?"

Market Trend Report: Maritime, Shipping & Transport Sector Advisory Services

Key Takeaways

- **Decarbonization driving specialized advisory demand:** Maritime consultancies are rapidly building dedicated energy transition capabilities, with [DNV](#) deploying at least 8 specialized roles in hydrogen, carbon capture (CCUS), and Power-to-X technologies, while creating a dedicated "Service Centre for Green Fleet Renewal" in Norway ^[1]. This capability build-out reflects intensifying demand as shipping operators face stricter IMO and EU emissions regulations through 2030.
- **Big Four consultancies generating \$177B+ in combined annual revenue:** The major professional services firms serving maritime clients achieved substantial scale in recent years, with [Deloitte](#) at \$70.5B (2025), [PwC](#) at \$55.4B (2024), [KPMG](#) at \$38.4B (2024), and [McKinsey & Company](#) at \$16B (2023) . Their aggressive hiring in maritime-adjacent sectors signals expanding advisory capacity.
- **Partnerships reveal market evolution toward integrated solutions:** Recent collaborations demonstrate advisory firms are moving beyond traditional consulting into technology-enabled service delivery, including [Lloyd's Register Group](#)'s training partnership with Grandi Navi Veloci on fleet decarbonization and RINA's technology demonstration center with Maritime and Port Authority of Singapore focusing on smart ships and digital ports ^[6].
- **Specialized maritime advisors facing consolidation pressure:** Pure-play maritime consultancies like [Drewry Shipping Consultants](#) (Mosaic Score 593) operate in markets showing slower growth signals, with the World Container Index falling 4.24% in March 2025 reflecting broader shipping industry volatility ^[7]. This market instability may accelerate consolidation as smaller advisors struggle to maintain relevance.

Market Dynamics

The maritime, shipping, and transport advisory services market is experiencing fundamental restructuring driven by regulatory mandates and technological transformation. The [Marine energy storage & hybrid powertrains](#) market recorded \$92M in equity funding over the past two years with an average Mosaic Score of

656 and median Commercial Maturity of "Scaling," indicating advisory opportunities around electrification are maturing rapidly [8]. Similarly, the [Maritime voyage & fuel optimization software](#) market shows an average Mosaic Score of 611 with \$7.9M in recent funding, suggesting advisory demand around operational efficiency remains robust [9].

Advisory firms are responding with aggressive capability expansion. [DNV's](#) revenue grew from \$2.6B (2022) to \$3.1B (2024), representing consistent double-digit growth, while maintaining a Mosaic Score of 754 that places it well above the 370 average for private companies. The company completed 23 acquisitions including cybersecurity (CyberOwl, Security Academy), Latin American energy infrastructure (Automa), and healthcare technology (Recare, Patients Know Best), signaling diversification beyond traditional maritime certification [11]. [Lloyd's Register Group](#) demonstrates similar momentum with 8% headcount growth over the past year and a Mosaic Score of 763 [12].

Commercial maturity data reveals advisory services are transitioning from purely consultative models to technology-enabled delivery. [McKinsey & Company](#) deployed approximately 12,000 AI agents internally to support consultants while expanding technology delivery capabilities through McKinsey Digital, hiring extensively for software engineers, data engineers, and cloud engineers. [Deloitte](#) is building AI Assurance practices in Singapore using proprietary "Trustworthy AI" methodology to apply frameworks like NIST AI RMF and ISO/IEC 42001 to client environments.

Growth Drivers

Decarbonization compliance mandates: Maritime operators face escalating regulatory pressure from IMO Net-Zero Framework penalties starting in the late 2020s and EU ETS compliance requirements. Advisory demand is concentrated around alternative fuel selection, with [DNV's](#) Brazil-Europe green corridor feasibility study finding biodiesel 43% more expensive than fossil fuels, green ammonia 65% higher, and methanol 109% higher — creating urgent need for economic viability assessments [11]. [Lloyd's Register Group](#) is conducting training programs with ferry operator Grandi Navi Veloci addressing IMO and EU regulatory frameworks alongside operational best practices for biofuels and LNG [6]. Point-source carbon capture technologies are expanding to offshore platforms through partnerships like Carbon Clean's deployment with MODEC for floating production vessels, targeting 300,000 tonnes of CO2 capture annually [17].

Fleet renewal and modernization pressures: Aging vessel fleets combined with new emissions standards are forcing operators to make substantial capital allocation decisions between retrofitting existing assets versus ordering new tonnage. [Lloyd's Register Group](#) awarded Approval in Principle for a 3,100 TEU dual-fuel ammonia-powered feeder ship design in May 2024, demonstrating advisory firms are directly involved in next-generation vessel specification [12]. Advisory services around asset lifecycle decisions are particularly

valuable given the 20-30 year operational lives of maritime vessels and the uncertainty around which alternative fuel pathways will achieve commercial scale.

Digital transformation and automation adoption: Maritime operators are deploying connected vessel technologies, predictive maintenance systems, and autonomous operations capabilities that require specialized implementation guidance. The [Transportation management systems \(TMS\)](#) market recorded \$286.2M in funding over the past two years across 23 deals, with companies averaging 234.7% headcount growth over two years ^[18]. [McKinsey & Company](#) secured strategic partnerships with OpenAI and AppliedAI for enterprise AI deployment, documenting case studies showing 99%+ reduction in manual effort and cycle time compression from weeks to minutes . Tech Mahindra partnered with ParkourSC to deliver AI-powered supply chain solutions reporting 20% waste reduction and 4X+ documented ROI ^[6].

Supply chain restructuring and nearshoring: Geopolitical tensions and pandemic-era disruptions accelerated supply chain reconfiguration, with companies diversifying manufacturing locations and transportation routes. [Deloitte](#) is expanding Latin America delivery centers in Costa Rica, Mexico, and Chile to support nearshoring advisory work, with multiple SAP, Oracle, and ServiceNow implementation roles explicitly tagged to the Americas Delivery Mexico (ADMX) center in Queretaro . This infrastructure build-out positions advisory firms to capture consulting fees from supply chain redesign projects extending through the end of the decade.

Private equity activity in logistics and maritime: Financial sponsor interest in transportation assets is driving demand for commercial due diligence, operational improvement programs, and value creation planning. [McKinsey & Company](#) established two "Strategy& Deals Tech Strategy AI & Tech Value Creation" roles (Director and Senior Manager) targeting PE firms on AI-driven value creation, signaling positioning of AI diligence as a premium deals service . [Boston Consulting Group](#) is aggressively hiring Partners across five ASEAN financial services markets, suggesting expansion into PE advisory alongside operational consulting .

Key Players & Positioning

Incumbents

Company	Revenue	Mosaic Score	Positioning
Deloitte	\$70.5B (2025) ^[2]	N/A	Big Four leader deploying internal generative AI copilot to 100,000 employees ^[16]

			, building AI Assurance practice for maritime regulatory compliance [15]
PwC	\$55.4B (2024) [3]	761 [22]	Strategic AI partnerships with OpenAI and Anthropic [23] , training 30,000 U.S. employees on Claude Code [23]
KPMG	\$38.4B (2024) [4]	740 [24]	Anthropic partnership embedding Claude across 276,000-person workforce [25] , designated preferred consultant for Anthropic's private equity clients [25]
McKinsey & Company	\$16.0B (2023) [5]	734 [19]	Deployed 12,000 AI agents internally [13] , co-invested \$4B in OpenAI Deployment Company [14]
Boston Consulting Group	\$13.5B (2025) [26]	785 [27]	250+ person AI Factory [20] , ASEAN financial services expansion across five markets [21]

Specialized Maritime Advisors

Company	Revenue	Mosaic Score	Positioning
DNV	\$3.1B (2024) [10]	754 [11]	Maritime classification leader, completed 23 acquisitions [11] , building hydrogen and CCUS technical capabilities [1]
Lloyd's Register Group	N/A	763 [12]	262-year heritage in maritime safety, acquired Ocean Technologies Group and OneOcean for digital capabilities [28] , naval and defense sector expansion [29]
Drewry Shipping Consultants	N/A	593 [7]	Maritime intelligence provider, World Container Index benchmark [30] , 14% headcount growth despite market volatility [30]

Emerging Trends

Funding patterns show maritime technology moving from pilots to procurement: The oil and gas technology sector, which overlaps significantly with maritime advisory through emissions monitoring and carbon capture, is experiencing a shift from experimental deployments to core infrastructure adoption. Industrial drone mapping & monitoring average Mosaic scores rose 17.2% over the past 12 months as

drone-based emissions monitoring moves from pilots to operational infrastructure, with Israel-based Percepto becoming the first robotics-led system approved under EPA rule changes in October 2025 [17]. Gas leak detection & flaring reduction market saw average M&A probability jump 32.2% in 6 months, validated when Kuva Systems was acquired by Sensirion Connected Solutions in June 2025 [17].

Partnership activity reveals convergence toward integrated service delivery: Strategic alliances demonstrate advisory firms are embedding themselves deeper into technology implementation rather than remaining at the strategy layer. SEKO Logistics partnered with STRATDEF Logistics to extend defense/government logistics coverage in EMEA via localized security clearance capability [6]. Tech Mahindra partnered with ParkourSC to deliver AI-powered digital supply chain solutions globally, targeting pharmaceutical and cold chain logistics with expansion to food, retail, and industrial sectors [6]. Clear Carbon integrated Sea's maritime emissions tracking into its enterprise carbon platform to address shipping emissions governance gaps for organizations facing mandatory climate disclosure requirements [6].

Hiring signals indicate AI transformation at industrial scale: Major consultancies are making organizational bets on AI capabilities through centralized capability builds and practice-wide embedding of AI expertise. [Boston Consulting Group](#) is building a 250+ person AI Factory to integrate fragmented tech capabilities into a unified engineering unit, with specialized roles focused on agentic AI and LLM engineering. [McKinsey & Company](#) maintains hiring momentum in the top 7% of companies with 649 open positions focused on AI, data science, and technology delivery roles. [Deloitte](#) ranks in the top 1% of companies for hiring momentum with 14,019 open positions, targeting 50,000 new hires in India alone within three years.

Naval and defense sector expansion by maritime advisors: Specialized maritime consultancies are deliberately expanding into defense markets, leveraging technical expertise to diversify beyond commercial shipping. [Lloyd's Register Group](#) is hiring a Head of Naval Liaison Office in Australia to lead relationships with regional government agencies and navies, a Senior Naval Consultant focused on extending operational life of naval assets, and a Lead Submarine Structures Specialist developing LR's Submarine Assurance Framework. This coordinated hiring across technical, advisory, and business development functions signals a strategic push into defense markets.

Solution Categories

The maritime, shipping, and transport advisory market encompasses several specialized service categories:

Decarbonization strategy and compliance advisory addresses regulatory requirements including IMO emissions targets, EU ETS compliance, and carbon reporting mandates. Services include alternative fuel pathway selection (hydrogen, ammonia, methanol, biofuels), retrofit versus newbuild economic analysis, carbon credit procurement and verification, and preparation for CII (Carbon Intensity Indicator) and EEXI

(Energy Efficiency Existing Ship Index) regulations. DNV's work on green corridor feasibility studies for Brazil-Europe routes and Lloyd's Register Group's training programs with Grandi Navi Veloci exemplify this category .

Digital transformation and operational optimization covers implementation of connected vessel technologies, predictive maintenance systems, voyage optimization software, and fleet performance management platforms. The [Maritime voyage & fuel optimization software](#) market includes pre-voyage planning, real-time monitoring and re-routing, post-voyage analytics, and emissions reporting with integrations to ECDIS, fleet performance, and chartering systems [9]. Tech Mahindra's partnership with ParkourSC delivering AI-driven supply chain solutions demonstrates the convergence of maritime operations with broader logistics optimization [6].

Fleet renewal and modernization planning provides technical and financial advisory around capital allocation decisions for aging vessel fleets. Services include lifecycle cost analysis comparing retrofit options versus newbuild investment, specification development for next-generation vessels incorporating alternative propulsion and fuel systems, and financing structure design. Lloyd's Register Group's Approval in Principle work on dual-fuel ammonia-powered feeder ships represents this category [12].

Supply chain network redesign assists shippers and logistics operators in restructuring transportation routes, modal choices, and distribution networks in response to geopolitical shifts, nearshoring trends, and cost pressures. The [Transportation management systems \(TMS\)](#) market provides planning, executing, and optimizing movement of goods across all transportation modes, enabling real-time visibility and workflow automation [18]. Deloitte's expansion of Latin America delivery centers in Costa Rica, Mexico, and Chile positions the firm to support nearshoring advisory projects [15].

AI governance and assurance services address emerging regulatory requirements around AI system deployment, particularly in safety-critical maritime applications. Deloitte's AI Assurance practice in Singapore applies frameworks like NIST AI RMF and ISO/IEC 42001 to client environments, targeting EU AI Act, DORA, and ISO 42001 compliance . As autonomous vessel systems and AI-driven operations centers proliferate, demand for specialized assurance services will grow.

Private equity operational improvement programs support financial sponsors acquiring logistics, shipping, and port assets through commercial due diligence, post-acquisition value creation initiatives, and exit preparation. McKinsey & Company's dedicated Strategy& Deals roles targeting PE firms on AI-driven value creation and KPMG's designation as Anthropic's preferred consultant for private equity clients indicate advisory firms are building specialized financial sponsor capabilities .

Future Considerations

Current state: The maritime advisory market is experiencing a fundamental shift from traditional consultative services toward technology-enabled delivery models and specialized regulatory compliance support. Major professional services firms generated combined revenues exceeding \$177B in their most recent fiscal years , while specialized maritime advisors like [DNV](#) and [Lloyd's Register Group](#) maintain strong positioning with Mosaic Scores of 754 and 763 respectively, well above the 370 average . The market is characterized by aggressive capability building in AI, with firms deploying thousands of internal AI agents and embedding AI literacy across consulting teams ^[20].

Headwinds: Traditional maritime advisory services face commoditization pressure as automation reduces demand for routine analysis and reporting. [Drewry Shipping Consultants](#) operates in markets showing volatility signals, with the World Container Index falling 4.24% in March 2025 reflecting weak demand and excess capacity . Pure-play maritime consultancies risk being squeezed between larger generalist firms with broader capabilities and specialized technology providers offering point solutions. Economic uncertainty highlighted by stalled growth in key markets like Australia threatens discretionary consulting spending ^[25]. Regulatory scrutiny of Big Four market concentration and conflicts of interest could limit growth opportunities or force structural changes ^[23].

Tailwinds: Decarbonization mandates create sustained advisory demand through 2030 and beyond, as maritime operators must navigate complex technology choices, regulatory compliance requirements, and capital allocation decisions under uncertainty. IMO Net-Zero Framework penalties and EU ETS expansion will drive continuous need for strategic guidance . Supply chain restructuring driven by geopolitical realignment and nearshoring trends generates consulting opportunities around network redesign, modal optimization, and technology implementation . Private equity activity in logistics and maritime assets provides recurring revenue streams through buy-side due diligence, operational improvement programs, and exit preparation services . Digital transformation adoption is accelerating, with companies doubling AI spending to 1.7% of revenue in 2026 according to research from [Boston Consulting Group](#) ^[20]. Advisory firms that successfully integrate AI capabilities into service delivery can capture premium pricing and recurring revenue streams, as evidenced by client outcomes including 5x productivity improvements and cycle time reductions from weeks to days .

Sources

1. [DNV Hiring](#)
2. [Deloitte Revenue](#)
3. [PwC Revenue](#)
4. [KPMG Revenue](#)

5. [McKinsey & Company Revenue](#)
6. [Relationship Search Results](#)
7. [Drewry Shipping Consultants](#)
8. [Marine energy storage & hybrid powertrains](#)
9. [Maritime voyage & fuel optimization software](#)
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